Everett made that clear—and also showed how much his estimate of the work involved had already changed, in light of the reaction from Copenhagen:

> [Resolving the issues with Bohr] is going to take a lot of time, a lot of heavy arguments with a practical tough-minded man like Bohr, and a lot of writing and rewriting. The combination of qualities, to accept corrections in a humble spirit, but to insist on the soundness of certain fundamental principles, is one that is rare but indispensable; and you have it. But it won't do much good unless you go and fight with the greatest fighter. Frankly, I feel about 2 more months of nearly solid day by day argument are needed to get the bugs out of the words, not out of the formalism [i.e. the idea of the universal wave function].

Wheeler also wrote back to Stern, vigorously defending the universal wave function—while eagerly displaying his own support for Bohr and the Copenhagen interpretation. Even more astonishing, he claimed that Everett supported the Copenhagen interpretation as well:

> I would not have imposed upon my friends the burden of analyzing Everett's ideas… if I did not feel that the concept of "universal wave function" offers an illuminating and satisfactory way to present the content of quantum theory. I do not in any way question the self consistency and correctness of the present quantum mechanical formalism when I say this. On the contrary, I have vigorously supported and expect to support in the future the current and inescapable approach to the measurement problem. To be sure, Everett may have felt some questions on this point in the past, but I do not. Moreover, I think I may say that this very fine and able and independently thinking young man has gradually come to accept the present approach to the measurement problem as correct and self consistent, despite a few traces that remain in the present thesis, draft of a past dubious attitude. So, to avoid any possible misunderstanding, let me say that Everett's thesis is not meant to question the present approach to the measurement problem, but to accept it and generalize it.

Several days later, Wheeler followed up with another letter to Everett, enclosing Stern's letter and his own reply to Stern. This letter suggests he had become still more concerned about the difficulty of reconciling Everett's ideas with Bohr's. "Your thesis must receive heavy revision of words and discussion, very little of mathematics, before I can rightfully take the responsibility to recommend it for acceptance. Moreover, I think it will